

UPSC Civil Services (Main) Simulation GS-I

DETAILED SOLUTIONS / ANSWER KEY | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

Q1. Explain how wave refraction and differential erosion produce the headland-bay coastal pattern.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (94 words; practice model, not official): Refraction concentrates energy on resistant projections and disperses it in bays, but rock structure, sediment and storm history control the realised form. Wave fronts slow in shallow water and bend toward the shore, concentrating energy on headlands and dispersing it in bays; refraction redistributes rather than creates wave energy. Hydraulic action, abrasion or corrasion, attrition and solution attack exposed coasts, with effectiveness controlled by wave energy, joints, lithology and beach protection. Differential erosion leaves resistant rock as headlands and recesses weaker rock into bays, while refraction reinforces the contrast by focusing energy on projections.

Q2. Classify islands by origin and explain why present shape alone is inadequate.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (119 words; practice model, not official): Continental, volcanic, coral and depositional origins reflect different crustal and sedimentary histories that can converge on similar present shapes. Islands may be continental fragments or shelf islands, oceanic volcanic islands, coral islands or depositional islands; classification must state the origin criterion. Continental islands share continental crustal or shelf affinity and may be separated by drowning, faulting or erosion; proximity to a continent alone does not prove origin. Oceanic volcanic islands grow where magma builds edifices above sea level at plate boundaries or hotspots; volcanic origin does not imply current eruptive activity. Coral islands are low accumulations of reef-derived carbonate sediment built and reworked by organisms, waves and currents; the living reef and the island landform are related but distinct.

Q3. Explain why industrial location cannot be reduced to raw-material proximity.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (90 words; practice model, not official): Raw material matters through weight, bulk and transport cost, but market, energy, labour, skills, agglomeration, infrastructure, policy and technology jointly determine the observed location. Jamshedpur demonstrates ore-coal-rail logic, while Bengaluru demonstrates skill, network and knowledge-economy advantages. Port petrochemical complexes use imported feedstock and coastal logistics, whereas automobile clusters depend on supplier ecosystems and markets. Weber explains least-cost pressures, but agglomeration economies, multiple markets, state policy and footloose activities relax his assumptions. Industrial location is a changing weighted combination of material, market, network and institutional factors rather than a one-factor rule.

Q4. Explain why separate residence in urban India does not by itself prove the decline of the joint family.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (107 words; practice model, not official): Structural nuclearisation can advance while remittance, ritual participation and deferred decision authority keep the family functionally joint, so residence and function must be assessed separately. A joint family is a multi-generational arrangement that may share residence, property, income or obligations; co-residence is an important form, but family functions can persist across separate households. A nuclear family household consists of parents and their unmarried children and has become more common with urban migration, housing constraints and occupational mobility. Structural nuclearisation is the shift to separate, smaller-household residence, while functional nuclearisation would additionally mean independence from intergenerational financial support and decision authority, and the two do not move together.

Q5. Explain the jajmani system and account for its transformation in contemporary rural India.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (99 words; practice model, not official): Jajmani was a hereditary, personalised patron-client exchange rather than a cash-free economy, and commercialisation, non-farm work and migration monetised it into contractual labour while leaving ritual service ties in place. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test.

Q6. Why did Curzon's policies accelerate militant nationalism?

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (103 words; practice model, not official): Curzon joined administrative centralisation and cultural arrogance with a partition perceived as political division, turning Moderate disillusion into an active programme. Curzon's Calcutta Corporation Act of 1899 reduced elected Indian influence and symbolised an anti-representative official turn. The Indian Universities Act of 1904 increased official supervision over universities and intensified nationalist distrust of Curzon. Moderate limitations, colonial repression, economic distress, cultural self-assertion and Asian victories encouraged militant nationalism. Curzon's partition of Bengal was announced in July 1905 and was presented officially as an administrative reorganisation. Nationalists interpreted Bengal partition as a political attempt to divide a growing Bengali public and weaken anti-colonial mobilisation.

Q7. Why did the Khilafat issue give Gandhi a workable platform for Hindu-Muslim unity in 1920?

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (106 words; practice model, not official): Khilafat offered an emotionally resonant, genuinely popular anti-imperial cause among Indian Muslims, and Gandhi's link to Swaraj converted a religious grievance into shared national action, though its foundation outside Indian control made the unity structurally fragile. Indian Muslims feared harsh Allied treatment of the Ottoman Sultan-Caliph after the First World War and the Treaty of Sevres, feeding the Khilafat agitation. Khilafat leadership included Maulana Mohammad Ali, Shaukat Ali, Maulana Azad, Hakim Ajmal Khan and Hasrat Mohani, with a Khilafat Committee already active before the November 1919 Delhi conference. The All-India Khilafat Conference at Delhi in November 1919 threatened withdrawal of cooperation if Khilafat demands were rejected.

Q8. Distinguish non-alignment from neutrality with reference to India's foreign policy between 1947 and 1961.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (99 words; practice model, not official): Non-alignment meant independent, case-by-case engagement with international questions, formalised at Belgrade in 1961, rather than a passive refusal to take positions. The Bandung Conference of April 1955 brought together twenty-nine Afro-Asian states around anti-colonialism and peaceful coexistence, with Nehru a leading voice alongside Sukarno, Nasser and Zhou Enlai; it was a precursor Afro-Asian gathering and not the founding summit of the Non-Aligned Movement. The Belgrade Conference of September 1961 was the founding summit of the Non-Aligned Movement, with Nehru, Tito, Nasser, Sukarno and Nkrumah among its principal founders; non-alignment was framed as independent, positive engagement rather than passive neutrality.

Q9. Why should Indo-Islamic architecture be read through coexistence of trabeate and arcuate systems rather than through a clean civilisational break?

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (127 words; practice model, not official): Indo-Islamic architecture is best explained as coexistence with expansion, not as replacement. Trabeate post-and-lintel work continued inside Sultanate and Mughal buildings, while scientifically executed arches, vaults and domes - helped by stronger lime mortar - widened span, height and skyline. Satish Chandra is explicit that arches and domes were known earlier; what changed was their large-scale, confident use. This is why Alai Darwaza matters more than slogan-level claims about origin. The same logic explains hybridity. Local craftsmen, local stone and familiar motifs such as lotus or bell continue inside the new vocabulary. Architecture therefore records technological transfer within an existing craft world, not the arrival of a sealed foreign style onto an empty field. A strong answer must conclude that Indo-Islamic architecture is structurally innovative without being culturally discontinuous.

Q10. Distinguish the Concert of Europe from the Holy Alliance.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (91 words; practice model, not official): The Concert was the broader practical habit of great-power consultation; the Holy Alliance was a narrower symbolic conservative compact among Russia, Austria and Prussia. The Concert was a diplomatic habit of great-power consultation and periodic congresses, not a permanent treaty-state or the same institution as the Holy Alliance. The Holy Alliance of Russia, Austria and Prussia supplied symbolic conservative language but had limited practical importance compared with the wider Concert. At Aix-la-Chapelle in 1818 France was readmitted to great-power consultation, showing that the defeated power was reintegrated rather than permanently excluded.

Q11. Assess India's Himalayan temperate forests as the subcontinental parallel of the cool temperate western-margin biome.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (172 words; practice model, not official): India has no true British-type maritime climate, but the mid-to-upper Himalayas carry a temperate deciduous-coniferous belt controlled by altitude rather than latitude, with deodar, oak, chir pine and

dry-temperate species in distinct belts. India has no true British-type maritime climate, but the mid-to-upper Himalayas carry the country's temperate deciduous and coniferous forest belt, the subcontinental parallel controlled by altitude rather than latitude. Himalayan moist temperate forests span the western and eastern Himalayan middle elevations with oak, chestnut and mixed broadleaf-conifer species; deodar, magnolia, cedar, maple and silver-fir characterise the montane wet temperate belt from J and K to Arunachal at 1500 to 3300 metres. Chir pine dominates the drier subtropical montane slopes in the NW Himalaya, HP, Uttarakhand, Arunachal and NE hill slopes at 100 to 200 cm rain and 15 to 22 degrees Celsius; it is highly fire-prone because of its resinous needles. Himalayan dry temperate forests occur chiefly in the inner western Himalayan ranges including Ladakh margins, Lahaul-Spiti and Kinnaur rain-shadow valleys, with deodar, chilgoza and juniper as characteristic species.

Q12. Assess the Himalayan altitudinal zonation as India's analogue of the Siberian boreal belt.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (189 words; practice model, not official): India lacks continental taiga but the Himalayan coniferous belt from subtropical chir pine through temperate deodar and silver-fir to alpine pastures mirrors the boreal sequence altitudinally; the economic role of softwood and the alpine pastoral economy parallel the taiga. India has no continental taiga, but the upper Himalayan coniferous and alpine belt is its altitudinal analogue of the cold-continental softwood forest, capped by alpine pastures above the treeline. The Himalaya show vertical or altitudinal zonation of vegetation from humid tropical through coniferous forest to alpine pastures; at the highest altitudes are the alpine pastures called mergs or bugyals used by tribals to graze cattle in summer. Silver-fir or *Abies* occurs at about 2200 to 3000 metres in the NW and NE Himalaya and is used for planking, wood-pulp, paper and matchsticks; spruce or *Picea smithiana* occupies the high wet-temperate belt; deodar or *Cedrus deodara* is a durable conifer timber of the western Himalayan temperate belt. Above the coniferous belt lie alpine scrub and meadows called bugyals or mergs, then snow; the treeline marks the ecological limit of trees and is an indicator of climate change when it shifts upward.

Q13. Explain the distribution of offshore petroleum reserves and how it differs from onshore occurrence.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (146 words; practice model, not official): Offshore petroleum reflects a distinct depositional and tectonic setting on thick passive-margin sediment prisms, and it imposes a different capital, technological, environmental and jurisdictional regime rather than being onshore petroleum placed under water. Oil and gas require source rock, reservoir rock, an impermeable seal and a trap geometry together, so a sedimentary basin is necessary but not sufficient for petroleum. Continental shelves and slopes act as great sediment sinks, oxygen-poor marine bottom water preserves organic matter, and passive margins accumulate thick undisturbed sediment prisms with deltaic and salt-tectonic traps. Offshore petroleum needs very high lumpy capital and large fields, works through platforms, subsea pipelines and coastal landfill terminals, and carries marine spill risk and maritime jurisdictional questions that onshore fields do not. India combines onshore Assam-Arakan and Cambay basins with a major western offshore province and east-coast deltaic offshore gas in the Krishna-Godavari and Cauvery margins.

Q14. Why is caste identity in India simultaneously negotiable in rank and rigid in boundary?

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (214 words; practice model, not official): Rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, land, office and market position, while the boundary is rigid because marriage reproduces it, which is why rising intercaste marriage and undiminished caste identity can coexist. Caste rank is negotiable because it is locally constructed through emulation, market position and political assertion, while the marriage boundary is not, because endogamy is the mechanism that reproduces caste across generations. M.N. Srinivas's Sanskritisation is the process by which a lower or middle caste adopts the dietary, ritual and marriage practices of a locally higher-status caste to claim higher local status; it is a claim to mobility rather than proof that acceptance or material mobility follows. A dominant caste is numerically strong, owns a significant share of local land and wields political influence in a locality, whether or not it ranks highest ritually, so dominance is a better predictor of everyday local power than ritual rank. Urbanisation, schooling and non-farm employment have broken most hereditary occupational allocation, making the caste-occupation link the weakest joint of the system, although stigmatised occupations and their inheritance have not disappeared. Endogamy is the most consistently observed feature and operates together with gotra exogamy, which forbids marriage within the same clan lineage, so the two rules are complementary rather than contradictory.

Q15. Examine why the quality of rehabilitation, rather than the fact of displacement, determines tribal development outcomes.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (192 words; practice model, not official): Displacement removes a subsistence and identity base, so the welfare sign of a project is set by whether resettlement restores land, livelihood and community rather than by whether compensation was paid. Mineral, forest and hydel-power resources are concentrated in tribal-majority regions, which creates a structural pressure for development projects to be sited exactly where tribal communities live. Mining, dam and industrial projects have repeatedly removed tribal communities from the land and forest base on which subsistence and identity depend, which is why tribal and national development are experienced as a trade-off rather than a shared gain. Restoration-oriented rehabilitation rebuilds land access, livelihood and community structure at the new site, while compensation-oriented rehabilitation pays money without guaranteeing

livelihood continuity or keeping a village together. Where rehabilitation restores livelihood and keeps the community intact, displacement can coexist with long-run welfare gain, and where it does not, displacement produces cumulative marginalisation, so rehabilitation quality is the decisive variable. Land alienation is the slower, cumulative transfer or encroachment of tribal land to non-tribal ownership through debt, distress sale or encroachment, and it is a different mechanism from a single project displacement event requiring a different remedy.

Q16. How did overseas networks transform Indian revolutionary politics before and during the First World War?

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (199 words; practice model, not official): London, Paris, the Pacific coast, Berlin and Kabul linked propaganda, migration, arms and wartime diplomacy, making Indian anti-colonialism a transnational security problem for the empire. Shyamji Krishna Varma founded India House in London; Savarkar later became a central organiser there but was not its founder. On 1 July 1909 Madan Lal Dhingra killed Sir William Curzon-Wyllie in London, bringing India House under intensified surveillance. Madame Bhikaji Cama and S.R. Rana worked through Paris and European platforms; Cama's Stuttgart flag episode occurred in 1907. Before Ghadar, Tarak Nath Das published Free Hindustan and G.D. Kumar published Swadesh Sevak among Indian migrants on the Pacific coast. The Hindi Association of the Pacific Coast was organised in May 1913 with Sohan Singh Bhakna as president and Lala Har Dayal as a key leader. The Ghadar paper appeared first in Urdu in late 1913, followed by a Gurmukhi edition, from the Yugantar Ashram printing centre. The Komagata Maru episode of 1914 exposed racial exclusion and sharpened diasporic anger without requiring unsupported casualty totals. The Berlin or Indian Independence Committee sought German assistance during the First World War and supported a provisional-government attempt at Kabul; Hindu-German conspiracy is an umbrella judicial label.

Q17. Assess the Swarajist experiment in the legislatures between 1923 and the later 1920s.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (164 words; practice model, not official): Council-entry exposed dyarchy's structural weakness through obstruction and demonstration rather than legislative victory, but C.R. Das's 1925 death and later patronage politics eroded its momentum. Pro-changers led by C.R. Das and Motilal Nehru pressed their council-entry proposal at the Congress session at Gaya in December 1922, where it was rejected, prompting them to found the Swaraj Party. This package retains 1 January 1923 as the Party's working founding date, while noting that some compact sources instead date the founding to December 1922 itself; this source variance is flagged rather than silently resolved. Swarajists argued that entering councils would prevent political passivity and publicly expose the limits of dyarchy rather than legitimise it. The Swarajists performed strongly in the 1923 elections and used their position to expose the structural weaknesses of dyarchy and the budgetary settlement. C.R. Das's death in 1925 and the gradual erosion of obstruction as ministries and patronage drew some members in reduced Swarajist momentum through the later 1920s.

Q18. Assess India's official-language settlement between 1959 and 1967, distinguishing the constitutional position from the statutory and political settlement.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (168 words; practice model, not official): The Constitution set a fifteen-year horizon and left Parliament free to extend the use of English, and the extension was achieved by statute in 1963, forced into political clarity by the agitation of 26 January 1965, and given unambiguous legal fortification by the amending Act adopted on 16 December 1967. The Department of Official Language's own reproduction of Part XVII, consulted live on 31 August 2026, records that Article 343(1) makes Hindi in Devanagari script the official language of the Union, that Article 343(2) allowed English to continue for all official purposes of the Union for fifteen years from the commencement of the Constitution, and that Article 343(3) permits Parliament to provide by law for the use of English thereafter; the phrase 'associate official language' entered Indian usage through the Presidential order of April 1960 and the settlement later legislated, and it is not a term used in the Constitution's own text, so English must never be described as the Constitution's formally designated associate language.

Q19. Khajuraho should be read as a complete sacred landscape, not as a shorthand for erotic sculpture. Discuss.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (202 words; practice model, not official): Khajuraho becomes intelligible only when treated as a sacred landscape rather than a sensational subset of its imagery. The site belongs to the Chandella world of Jejabhukti and is distributed across western, eastern and southern clusters. Its temples are linked by a common Nagara architectural language: high jagati terraces, axial halls, sanctum-centred verticality and dense sculptural integration. Religious range is equally important. Surviving temples belong to Shaiva, Vaishnava, Surya, Ganesha and Jain traditions, showing that plurality is built into the site's identity. Sculptural breadth confirms this reading. Alongside loving couples appear worshippers, teachers, disciples, dancers, musicians, attendants and courtly figures. These registers give the stone surface movement and social texture. Erotic imagery is therefore real but not exhaustive; it is one strand within a wider sacred-secular programme. Kandariya Mahadeva is the best monument for showing how tower, wall and carving work together to create this total effect. Modern conservation also supports the landscape reading. UNESCO frames Khajuraho through clustered monuments, plan logic and cultural testimony, while ASI records material differences and surviving

groups. A mature answer should therefore reject reductionism: Khajuraho is memorable because it fuses architecture, devotion, patronage and human imagery into one of the richest temple landscapes of medieval India.

Q20. How far did alliances cause the First World War?

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (135 words; practice model, not official): Alliances structured escalation and encirclement fears but did not compel war; specific July decisions, nationalism and imperial insecurity remained decisive. The Triple Alliance of 1882 joined Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy, though Italy did not fight with them at the war's opening and entered on the Allied side in 1915. The 1894 Franco-Russian alliance helped organise Europe into counterweighted blocs and intensified German fear of encirclement. Britain and France reached the Entente Cordiale in 1904, resolving colonial disputes and enabling closer strategic cooperation. The 1907 British-Russian agreement completed the alignment commonly called the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia. German backing enabled Austria-Hungary's hard line and is central to arguments assigning heavy responsibility to Berlin and Vienna. Military timetables shortened diplomacy while leaders misjudged Russian, British and German responses; likelihood increased without making war inevitable.

END OF DETAILED SOLUTIONS